

| Key Topics                                                                      | Content<br>Learners should have studied the following:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
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| <b>The Middle East c.550–620</b>                                                | The structure of pre-Islamic Arabia in the mid 6 <sup>th</sup> Century, economic and social issues; religious beliefs in pre-Islamic Arabia; the commercial importance of Mecca; the influence of tribalism; the decline of the Byzantine and the Sassanian Empires and the impact on the Arab world; the impact of plague and warfare; Arab military strengths; the Meccan period c.570–620.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>The establishment of Islam c.620–632</b>                                     | The impact of Revelation and the hijra; the Medinan period c.622–632; challenges to the Prophet Muhammad; the flight of the Prophet Muhammad; the Constitution of Medina and its significance; the early growth of Islam and reasons for its appeal, the economy and its role in the rise of Islam.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>The beginning of the Empire and the rule of the 'Rightly Guided Caliphs'</b> | Disagreements about the succession; the succession of Abu Bakr (632); the Ridda Wars of Wars of Apostasy (632–633); the beginnings of the Empire and expansion into Persia, reasons for success; the rule of Abu Bakr (632–634), his emergence as Caliph, the nature of his rule and achievements; Umar ibn al-Khattab (634–644), the reasons for his rise, expansion and the governance of conquered lands, the treatment of non-Muslims, the fall of Damascus and Jerusalem (637); Uthman ibn Affan (644–656), early successes, growing internal problems, rebellion and the murder of Uthman; Ali ibn Abi Talib (656–661), opposition and arbitration. |
| <b>The establishment and expansion of the Umayyad Empire</b>                    | The rule of Mu'awiya (661–680), problems and achievements, succession crisis; the Second Fitna of 680; the rule of 'Abd al-Malik (685–705); the establishment of Syria and Damascus; expansion of the Empire in North Africa, Spain, the Middle East and Sindh and Punjab; relations with Christians; systems and methods of government; unrest, including the Third Fitna; decline of the Umayyad Empire.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |